This hearty, wholesome soup takes the edge off chilly winter weather. It's worth using dried beans, which have a much fuller flavor than the canned variety.

creamy kidney bean soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 3¼ HRS OR 30 MINS IN A PRESSURE COOKER **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS AT THE END OF STEP 3

8oz (225g) dried kidney beans, soaked overnight in cold water
2 red onions, diced
1 x 14oz (400g) can chopped tomatoes
1 tbsp tomato purée
5 garlic cloves, halved
2in (5cm) fresh ginger, coarsely chopped
3 large green chiles, left whole
salt and freshly ground black pepper
⅔ cup half-and-half
squeeze of fresh lime juice, to taste

for the garnish
4–6 red radishes, sliced
1 large green chile, finely chopped
2 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro leaves
squeeze of fresh lime juice, to taste

1 Drain the kidney beans, discarding the soaking liquid. Put the beans in a very large heavy-bottomed pan and cover with 1¾ quarts (1¾ liters) of water. Add the onions, tomatoes, tomato purée, garlic, ginger, and chiles and bring to a boil.

2 Cover the pan, lower the heat, and simmer for about 3 hours, until the beans are just breaking up. Add more liquid if needed during cooking. You could also use a pressure cooker—the beans will be tender in about 30 minutes.

3 Once the beans have cooled slightly, scoop out the chiles. Using a blender, process the soup in batches until smooth, then sieve to remove the skins. Season well with salt and pepper.

4 Stir in the half-and-half, and reheat. Add lime juice to taste. For the garnish, combine the sliced radish with the green chile and cilantro. Sharpen with a squeeze of lime, then top each bowl of soup with a small heap of the thin radishes.